MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 8

"Let It Be"

Episode 2x08. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x08. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Wednesday, November 9, 2005, 5:14 AM through 11:48 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x07

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Wednesday, November 9, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Wednesday, November 9, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	47
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern (on probation)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (26 weeks 5 days pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Mother Cornelia Haynes (new)	Patient: pancreatic head mass; retired Harlem Hospital nurse	Mar 2, 1924	81
Deborah Haynes-Price (new)	Cornelia's daughter; vice principal	May 17, 1950	55
Brandon Haynes-Price (new)	Cornelia's grandson; nursing student	Jul 8, 1983	22
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Deacon Otis 'Bulldog' Merriweather (new)	Patient: displaced femoral neck fracture	Aug 14, 1944	61
Mavis Merriweather (new)	Otis's wife	Feb 27, 1946	59
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Hattie 'Miss Hattie' Lomax	Cafeteria	Mar 3, 1945	60
Dr. Horace Whitlow	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband; chemistry teacher	Apr 3, 1975	30
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Winston Teague (new)	Patient: end-stage heart failure, LVAD	Jan 22, 1947	58
Pauline Teague (new)	Winston's wife	Sep 30, 1950	55
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Cedric Hall	Architect; Monty's partner	Jan 22, 1965	40
Simone Bracey (new)	Patient: colloid cyst, hydrocephalus	Feb 11, 1986	19

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Lester Grimes (new)	Patient: ACE-inhibitor angioedema	Jun 3, 1939	66
Dr. Yolanda Fitch (new)	ER Attending	May 12, 1961	44
Dr. Harold Bynum (new)	Consult-Liaison Psychiatrist	Oct 19, 1942	63
Gail Bracey (new)	Simone's mother	Aug 4, 1959	46
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	Fetal Surgeon; Esther's husband	Mar 3, 1971	34
Dr. Paulette Greenidge	Couples therapist, Brooklyn Heights	Aug 1, 1955	50
Dr. Malcolm Sloan (V.O., voicemail)	Plastic Surgeon, Boston	Feb 14, 1968	37

Also appearing: a CT radiologist, a GI attending, Mr. Kostas (the baker, off-screen), Mrs. Grimes, an anesthesiologist, scrub and circulating nurses, a CVICU nurse and the lunch crowd at Monty's. Mentioned: Lorna Ellison (by letter), Augustin Toussaint (by phone), Corinne Smilley, Josephine Bullock (by note), Victor Donohue, Grace Bullock, Howard Divine, Paul Tergat, Hendrick Ramaala, Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., and Drs. Aubre de L. Maynard, John W. V. Cordice and Emil Naclerio.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. ARIANNA'S APARTMENT - ABOVE THE BAKERY - ASTORIA - PRE-DAWN
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:14 AM

A small, spare rented room above a Greek bakery on 30th Avenue. The ovens downstairs are already going, and the floorboards are warm. Arianna (26) sits on the edge of her bed in a Pitt sweatshirt, a Dell laptop balanced on her knees, the dial-up modem shrieking.

On the screen: the NBME secure website. "USMLE STEP 2 CK -- SCORE REPORT AVAILABLE." Her cursor hovers. She clicks.

The page loads one line at a time. "RESULT: FAIL."

She doesn't move. Downstairs, Mr. Kostas drops a sheet pan and swears in Greek. Arianna closes the laptop very gently, as if it might go off.

MARC (V.O.)
Surgeons are taught to fix things. (beat) It's the whole job. Something's broken, you open it up, you put it right.

She opens the laptop again. Same line. "FAIL." Below it, in small print, the numbers she will memorize before she gets to work: three points short.

ARIANNA
(to the empty room, flat)
Okay. (beat) Okay.

2 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - PRE-DAWN
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:41 AM

Natasha (47), in a cashmere wrap, a mug of tea going cold on the blotter. Franklin Bassett (47), General Counsel, in yesterday's suit, sets a FedEx envelope in front of her. Its letterhead reads "THE JOINT COMMISSION -- OFFICE OF QUALITY MONITORING."

BASSETT
It came to my house at nine last night. (beat) A courier. To my house, Natasha.

Natasha reads. Her face gives away nothing.

NATASHA
(reading aloud, even)
"...has received a complaint regarding potential conflicts of interest in the supervision and evaluation of a resident physician related to members of hospital leadership..." (beat) "...requests a written response..." (beat) "...reserves the right to conduct an unannounced for-cause survey."

BASSETT
(sitting)
It's anonymous. (beat) It's also Horace Whitlow. The second paragraph uses the word "nepotistic." Horace is the only man in Queens who still uses "nepotistic."

NATASHA
(setting the letter down)
What do you want to do, Franklin?

BASSETT
I want to go upstairs and throw his good tea set out the window. (beat) What I'll do is draft a response that buries them in documentation. (beat) And I want you to let me go after him.

NATASHA
(beat)
No.

BASSETT
Natasha...

NATASHA
(standing, going to the window)
If I fight Horace, it becomes a war about me. (beat) If I fight the Joint Commission, it becomes a war about my son. (beat) Neither of those is a war I win. (beat) We answer every question. We open every chart. (beat) And we let it be.

MARC (V.O.)
But sometimes the hardest thing a surgeon ever learns...

Across the river, the sky over Manhattan turns the color of a bruise. Natasha picks up the phone and dials one extension.

NATASHA
(into the phone)
Elxa. (beat) It's your mother. (beat) I need you in my office before rounds. (beat) Bring the call schedule.

MARC (V.O.)
...is when to keep their hands still.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:04 AM

The kitchen. On the refrigerator, under a Howard University magnet, is a note in a schoolteacher's perfect cursive: "Pound cake in the tin. Eat a vegetable. Call your father. -- Grandma." The small TV on the counter

plays NY1: "BLOOMBERG ROUTS FERRER, WINS SECOND TERM."

Marc (26) butters toast. Harmony (26) pours coffee. Amond (26) eats standing up, reading a cardiac journal. Raven (25) is at the counter, thumbing her RAZR.

HARMONY
(setting a mug in front of Marc, with a deep, theatrical bow)
Your coffee, Mr. Donohue. (beat) Would Mr. Donohue like his toast on a silver tray?

MARC
(dry)
It's been five days.

HARMONY
And I've got about six more weeks of this in me. (beat) You owe me a lot of jokes, Marc-Anthony.

AMOND
(not looking up)
She's earned them.

Raven snaps her phone shut, frowning.

RAVEN
Arianna's not answering. (beat) She always texts me back by six. She texts "k" just to make me crazy, but she texts back.

RAVEN
(beat)
It's Wednesday.

AMOND
(looking up now)
Oh. (beat) Scores.

A beat. Everyone in the kitchen knows what Wednesday means. Raven grabs her bag and is out the door before her

coffee's poured.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:31 AM

Banging lockers. Arianna changes into scrubs with her back to the room, moving fast. Raven comes in, out of breath.

RAVEN
(quietly)
Hey.

ARIANNA
(not turning around)
Hey.

ARIANNA
(turning, a hard, bright smile)
It's fine. It's a test. (beat)
We've got rounds.

Across the room, Kennerly (27) sits alone on the bench tying his shoes. Five days ago, people sat next to him. Now there's a full foot of empty bench on either side. Esther (26) walks past him without a glance. So does Harmony. He keeps tying his shoe.

Marc comes in, opens his locker, and stops. Taped inside, someone has stuck a Monopoly "Get Out of Jail Free" card. He looks at it, peels it off, and drops it in the trash.

ESTHER
(beside him, low)
That's the third one this week.

MARC
(beat)
Fourth. (beat) Somebody put a Rich Uncle Pennybags on my clipboard Monday.

ESTHER
(beat, almost smiling)
He does look a little like your grandfather.

It's the first thing she's said to him in days that wasn't about a patient. They both seem to notice. Esther closes her locker and goes.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:46 AM

The interns gather for assignments. Elxa (28), 26 weeks and 5 days pregnant, her scrub top stretched, a clipboard on her belly like a shelf. She looks like she's been up since four, and she has.

ELXA
Listen up. Effective today, by order of the Chief of Surgery, there are changes to the service schedule. (beat) Dr. Bullock will not rotate on, take call for, or be evaluated by Cardiothoracic or Obstetrics and Gynecology for the rest of his intern year.

Silence. Every head turns to Marc. Kennerly, at the back, watches with great interest.

ELXA
(continuing, flat)
Dr. Bullock's evaluations will be written by Dr. Lowery, Dr. Crump and Dr. Graves, and countersigned by the program director. I won't be evaluating him either. (beat) That's not a punishment. It's a firewall. Anybody who wants to make it into a punishment can come see me.

KENNERLY
(pleasantly)
What about Smilley?

Elxa turns very slowly.

KENNERLY
(shrugging)
Her husband's an attending. (beat) I'm just asking for consistency.

ELXA
(beat, ice)
Dr. Smilley hasn't scrubbed with Dr. Hartwell since Monday, by her own request, and she's going to Neuro. (beat) Thank you for your interest in consistency, Kennerly. You'll be in the ER with Nurse Pettiford, consistently, all day.

ELXA
(reading off)
Bullock, Ellison: Lowery, general. Baker: Cardio, with Dr. Robert Bullock. Smilley: Neuro, Dr. Graves. Divine: Ortho consult, Dr. Toussaint is waiting in the pit. Cummings: Lowery.

The interns scatter. Marc lingers.

MARC
(low)
Cardio. For the whole year.

ELXA
(beat, quieter)
Mama didn't have a choice, Marc. (beat) Whitlow went to the Joint Commission.

Marc absorbs that.

ELXA
(beat)
Every case you scrub from now on is going to be looked at by somebody who wants it to be dirty. (beat) So make them all clean.

MARC
They were always clean.

ELXA
(beat)
I know, baby brother. (beat) Now prove it on paper.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 3 - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:18 AM

MOTHER CORNELIA HAYNES (81), tiny and elegant in a lavender church suit she insisted on wearing to the ER, sits upright on the gurney. Her skin, a deep brown, has a faint gold cast. So do the whites of her eyes. Beside her, arms folded, stands her daughter DEBORAH HAYNES-PRICE (55), a vice principal in a pantsuit.

Lowery (58) reads the chart. Marc, Raven and Arianna stand at the foot of the bed.

LOWERY
Mrs. Haynes. I'm Dr. Lowery. (beat) These are Drs. Bullock, Ellison and Cummings.

CORNELIA
(bright, regal)
Mother Haynes, baby. I've been Mother Haynes at Abyssinian since 1979. Nobody's called me Mrs. since my husband passed.

LOWERY
(a small smile)
Mother Haynes.

DEBORAH
She's yellow. (beat) She's been yellow for a week and she told me it was the light in her kitchen.

RAVEN
(stepping up)
Mother Haynes, any pain? (beat) Any itching?

CORNELIA
(beat, admitting it)
Like the devil. At night.

RAVEN
Has your urine been dark? Stool pale?

CORNELIA
(smiling at her)
Tea and clay. (beat) You're good. (beat) I was a nurse at Harlem Hospital forty-four years, child. 1947 to 1991. (beat) I know what painless jaundice means in an eighty-one-year-old woman.

The room goes quiet. Deborah looks at her mother.

DEBORAH
What does it mean?

CORNELIA
(gently, to Lowery)
Go on and get your CT scan, Doctor. (beat) Then we'll all know together.

LOWERY
(quietly)
Yes, ma'am.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - THE PIT - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:26 AM

Chaos. Gloria Pettiford (53) commands the board like a general. Kennerly stands beside her, and she's ignoring him on purpose. Harmony crosses to a curtained bay where Camille Toussaint (29), in her Saints jacket over her scrubs, is examining DEACON OTIS "BULLDOG" MERRIWEATHER (61), a lean, silver-goateed man with a runner's legs. His right leg is shortened and rotated outward. His wife MAVIS (59) holds his hand.

CAMILLE
(not looking up)
Choir! Look at this leg and tell me what you see.

HARMONY
(looking)
Shortened. Externally rotated. (beat) Femoral neck fracture.

CAMILLE
(delighted)
She sings, she reads films. (beat) Deacon Merriweather ran the New York City Marathon on Sunday.

OTIS
(proudly, through gritted teeth)
My twentieth. Four fifty-one. (beat) Hip started hurting at mile eighteen in the Bronx. (beat) Twentieth one, I wasn't stopping.

MAVIS
(to Harmony)
He's been limping since Sunday. (beat) This morning he got off the Q32 bus, put his foot down, and went down like a tree.

CAMILLE
(to Harmony)
Stress fracture. He ran on it for eight miles. Then he walked on it for three days. (beat) This morning it let go.

OTIS
(wincing)
Did you see the finish Sunday? Tergat and Ramaala? (beat) Thirty-two hundredths of a second. Two men, twenty-six miles, and it came down to a lean.

OTIS
I'm running Boston in April.

Camille and Harmony exchange a look.

CAMILLE
(warmly)
Let's get you some pictures first, Deacon.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIOTHORACIC OFFICE - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:39 AM

Robert Bullock (49) at his desk. A plastic model of a heart pump, the HEARTMATE XVE, sits on the desk, heavy as a brick. Amond stands across from him with a chart.

ROBERT
(not looking up)
Winston Teague. Fifty-eight. Ischemic cardiomyopathy. Ejection fraction twelve percent. Creatinine two-point-four. (beat) Why isn't he getting a heart, Dr. Baker?

AMOND
(instantly)
Pulmonary vascular resistance is too high, and his kidneys aren't good enough. The transplant committee turned him down in August. (beat) He's a candidate for destination therapy.

ROBERT
Which means?

AMOND
The pump isn't a bridge to a transplant. (beat) The pump is the destination. It's the rest of his life.

Robert finally looks up.

ROBERT
The FDA approved this device for destination therapy three years ago this month. (beat) The REMATCH trial. Survival at one year was fifty-two percent with the pump and twenty-five percent without. (beat) That's not a miracle. It's a coin toss with a better coin.

AMOND
(beat)
He'd take the coin.

ROBERT
(beat)
How do you know?

AMOND
I talked to him at five this morning. (beat) His granddaughter's getting married in June at Riverside Church. (beat) He says he's going to play the drums at the reception if it kills him.

Robert almost smiles. Then his eyes go to the door, where Marc has stopped outside, holding a chart for someone else. Father and son look at each other through the glass. Marc keeps walking.

AMOND
(quietly)
It wasn't his fault, sir. The firewall.

ROBERT
(beat, looking back at the pump)
I know whose fault it was, Dr. Baker. (beat) Book the OR for one o'clock.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEUROSURGERY - READING ROOM - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:52 AM

Dim. Light boxes glowing. Dr. Leland Graves (52), tall and gray at the temples, stands in front of an MRI with his reading glasses pushed up on his forehead. Esther stands beside him.

GRAVES
Tell me what this is.

ESTHER
(studying the film)
A round lesion at the foramen of Monro, about a centimeter and a half. Hyperdense. Both lateral ventricles are enlarged. (beat) Colloid cyst with obstructive hydrocephalus.

GRAVES
What does a colloid cyst do?

ESTHER
It sits there for twenty years doing nothing. (beat) Then one day it plugs the drain and the patient dies in their sleep.

GRAVES
(beat, pleased)
Sudden death. It's in every textbook, and nobody believes it until it happens on their service. (beat) Simone Bracey. Nineteen. A sophomore at Queens College. Headaches for a month. Her mother found her this morning, vomiting and confused.

ESTHER
(beat)
We're operating today.

GRAVES
We're operating this morning. (beat) A transcallosal approach. You'll open.

Esther looks at him. Graves lowers his glasses.

GRAVES
(dry)
You held a retractor for me during a hurricane, Dr. Smilley. Hold the drill for me on a Wednesday.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:02 AM

A corner table. Raven sets down two coffees and sits across from Arianna, who is pretending to read a chart. Miss Hattie, behind the register, keeps one eye on them.

RAVEN
Three points? Four?

Arianna looks up sharply.

RAVEN
(beat)
You're pretending to read a chart, Problem. You'd never pretend in front of me if you'd passed. (beat) You'd be insufferable. You'd make me call you "Doctor" in bed.

ARIANNA
(beat, flat)
Three.

ARIANNA
(low, furious at herself)
My school didn't require it before graduation. I put it off. I took it the second week of October, after eighty-hour weeks and a hurricane and a train crash. (beat) And I missed it by three points.

RAVEN
When can you retake it?

ARIANNA
Sixty days after the last attempt. (beat) December twelfth. (beat) QGH doesn't issue PGY-2 contracts without a pass. If I fail twice they don't have to renew me.

RAVEN
Then you won't fail twice.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Ellison. Don't.

RAVEN
Don't what?

ARIANNA
Don't fix it. (beat) Don't make flashcards. Don't color-code anything. (beat) My father couldn't stay clean, and my mother couldn't stay here, in her head, and I raised myself in Pittsburgh by not letting anybody see me need anything. (beat) Just let it be my problem.

Raven looks at her for a long moment.

RAVEN
(gently)
You know what your nickname is, right?

ARIANNA
(beat)
Don't.

RAVEN
(standing, picking up her coffee)
It was never "no problem," Arianna. (beat) It was always "Problem." (beat) And I like you anyway.

She goes. Arianna stares at the coffee Raven left her. It has two sugars, exactly how she takes it.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - RADIOLOGY - CT READING ROOM - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:14 AM

Lowery, Marc and Raven stand behind the radiologist, scrolling through Cornelia's CT slice by slice.

RADIOLOGIST
Three-point-one centimeter hypodense mass in the head of the pancreas. Double duct sign: both the common bile duct and the pancreatic duct are dilated. (beat) The SMV is abutted but not encased. No liver lesions I can see. No ascites.

RAVEN
(quietly)
It's resectable.

LOWERY
(beat)
It's resectable on a picture.

MARC
A Whipple.

LOWERY
(turning to them)
Pancreaticoduodenectomy in an eighty-one-year-old woman. Six hours if it goes well. A two-week stay if it goes well. Maybe one in three get a major complication. (beat) Five-year survival in the best hands is maybe twenty percent.

RAVEN
But it's the only cure.

LOWERY
(beat)
It's the only chance of a cure, Dr. Ellison. You want to be a surgical oncologist, so learn the difference now. It'll save you a lot of nights.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 512 - DAY

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:41 AM

Cornelia, now in a gown with her church suit hung carefully in the closet and her pearls still on, sits in the bed. Deborah stands at the window. Her grandson BRANDON HAYNES-PRICE (22), a nursing student in Hunter-Bellevue scrubs, sits on the radiator. Lowery has just finished explaining. Marc and Raven stand at the foot of the bed.

DEBORAH
(instantly)
So you take it out. (beat) When? Today? Tomorrow?

LOWERY
(carefully)
It's a big operation, Mrs. Price. It's...

DEBORAH
My mother walked four miles at Riverbank last Saturday. She's not frail. She's not some...

CORNELIA
(quietly)
Deborah.

DEBORAH
She's going to have the surgery.

CORNELIA
(a little louder)
Deborah Ann.

Deborah stops. Cornelia looks at Lowery.

CORNELIA
Doctor, in your hands, how many of us eighty-one-year-olds walk out of here?

LOWERY
(beat, honest)
Most of them walk out, Mother Haynes. (beat) Not all. (beat) And the ones who walk out spend the next three months getting their strength back. Some never get all of it back.

CORNELIA
(beat)
And if I don't?

LOWERY
(gently)
Then you have months. Maybe six. Maybe less. (beat) We can put a stent in the duct so the yellow goes away and the itching stops. That's a procedure, not an operation.

CORNELIA
(folding her hands)
Then that's what I want.

DEBORAH
(turning)
No.

CORNELIA
(calm as Sunday)
I held the hand of every person who ever died on Ward K, baby. For forty-four years. (beat) I know what the hard way looks like, and I know what the easy way looks like. (beat) And I'm choosing.

DEBORAH
(tears starting, furious)
You don't get to quit on me.

CORNELIA
(beat, gently)
I'm not quitting, Deborah. (beat)
I'm letting it be.

Deborah walks out. Brandon looks at his grandmother, then at the door, torn, and follows his mother. Cornelia turns to Marc and Raven with a weary, gracious smile.

CORNELIA
(beat)
Which one of you is going to tell me I'm wrong?

Marc and Raven look at each other. Neither says a word.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - CORRIDOR - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:52 AM

Deborah paces by the elevators, wiping her eyes. Marc comes out of 512 and walks over to her. Raven hangs back.

DEBORAH
(without turning)
Are you the one who's the Chief's son?

Marc stops.

DEBORAH
(bitter)
The nurse at the desk said it like it was the weather. "That's the Chief's son." (beat) So you have pull. So you go in there and tell her to have the surgery.

MARC
(beat)
I don't have pull, Mrs. Price. (beat) And even if I did, it wouldn't change what your mother said.

DEBORAH
(turning on him)
My mother delivered half of Harlem. She buried my father, my brother and three of her sisters. She raised me alone after 1968. (beat) And now she's just going to lie there and let it eat her?

MARC
(quietly)
She's going to lie there and not be cut open from here to here, ma'am. (beat) That's not the same thing.

DEBORAH
(beat)
How old are you?

MARC
Twenty-six.

DEBORAH
(wiping her face)
Twenty-six. (beat) Wait till it's your mother.

The elevator opens. She gets in. The doors close on her. Marc stands there. Raven comes up beside him.

RAVEN
(beat)
She's not wrong, you know. (beat) It's resectable.

MARC
(beat)
Neither is her mother.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - THE PIT - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:08 AM

Kennerly suctions a drunk's scalp laceration in Bay 9. Gloria hands him a suture kit without a word.

KENNERLY
(not looking up)
You can say it, you know.

GLORIA
(beat)
Say what, Dr. Kennerly?

KENNERLY
Whatever everybody's saying. (beat) That I'm a snitch. That I'm a rat. (beat) Everybody else is saying it in the locker room.

GLORIA
(beat, checking a chart)
I've been a nurse in this ER for thirty years. (beat) I've seen a dozen interns like you. Smart. Mean. Hungry. Thinks somebody's always getting something he's not. (beat) Most of them grow out of it.

GLORIA
You gave that boy's name to the cafeteria. (beat) Don't expect anybody in here to save you a seat at lunch. (beat) But the man in Bay 9 doesn't care who your mama is. Or who you told what. (beat) Close his head.

Kennerly ties his first knot. It's perfect. Gloria notices, and says nothing.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF OF MEDICINE'S OFFICE - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:24 AM

Whitlow (56) pours tea from his good set: bone china, gold rim. Kennerly stands at the door, still in his ER gown.

WHITLOW
(not looking up)
I don't believe we have an appointment, Dr. Kennerly.

KENNERLY
(low)
The Joint Commission letter came. (beat) Dr. Bullock moved him off Cardio. Elxa announced it at rounds. (beat) You said nobody would know where it came from.

WHITLOW
(stirring)
Nobody does.

KENNERLY
Everybody does. (beat) They know it was me in the cafeteria. They'll figure out the rest.

WHITLOW
(setting down his spoon, mild)
Dr. Kennerly. You repeated a rumor to a nurse and a medicine resident. (beat) That's all you did. That's all anyone can prove. (beat) Anything else you think you know is your own imagination.

KENNERLY
(beat)
You said you'd write my letter. (beat) For a fellowship. You said you'd talk to the program director about my probation.

WHITLOW
(looking at him for the first time, pleasant and empty)
I don't recall that conversation. (beat) And I'd advise you not to recall it either. (beat) You're a surgical intern on probation, Dr. Kennerly. I'm the Chief of Medicine. (beat) We don't really know each other, do we?

Kennerly stands there. Whitlow sips his tea and goes back to his papers. Kennerly leaves. He's a man who just realized he was the bullet, not the gun.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:40 AM

Microscope draped. Simone Bracey's head is shaved in a neat strip and pinned in a Mayfield clamp. Graves, gowned, sits at the head of the table. Esther, gowned, holds a high-speed drill. The scrub nurse and the anesthesiologist watch the clock.

GRAVES
(calm)
Burr holes. Two. Paramedian, just right of the sagittal sinus, here and here. (beat) Dr. Smilley, if you go into the sinus, she'll bleed out faster than you can say "Joint Commission."

ESTHER
(steady)
I won't go into the sinus.

GRAVES
(beat)
Show me.

The drill whines. Bone dust. Esther's hands don't shake. The first burr hole goes through clean, the dura gleaming underneath. Then the second. Graves leans in.

GRAVES
(quietly)
Good. (beat) Again. The craniotome.

Esther connects the burr holes with the craniotome, and the bone flap comes up in one piece. Graves takes it from her and hands it to the scrub nurse.

GRAVES
(beat)
Your hands are better than they were in the hurricane.

ESTHER
(beat)
I've been practicing.

GRAVES
On what?

ESTHER
(beat)
Not falling apart.

Graves looks at her over his mask. Then he slides the microscope into place.

GRAVES
(gently)
Then let's see if it holds.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 12:02 PM

Russell Jeffries (30), Elxa's husband, a chemistry teacher in a tweed blazer with a lanyard that reads "AUGUST MARTIN HIGH SCHOOL," sets a foil-covered plate and a pamphlet on the counter. Elxa eyes both.

RUSSELL
Oxtails. My mother made them. (beat) And that's the Lamaze class at Jamaica Hospital. It starts the fifth of December. Monday nights. (beat) I signed us up.

ELXA
(lifting the foil, inhaling)
I'm on call Mondays.

RUSSELL
You're on call every day, Elxa.

ELXA
(beat)
I know how to breathe, Russell. I'm a surgeon.

RUSSELL
(gently)
You know how to make other people breathe. (beat) It's different.

Elxa looks at him. Then she picks up the pamphlet, reads it, and tucks it into her scrub pocket.

ELXA
(beat, grudging)
Mondays.

RUSSELL
(kissing her forehead)
Mondays.

ELXA
(beat)
If I'm late, you breathe for both of us.

RUSSELL
(beat, smiling)
I've been doing that since 2002.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ORTHOPEDICS - READING ROOM - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 12:14 PM

Otis's X-ray on the light box: a femoral neck fracture, displaced, the head of the femur tipped like a bottle cap. Camille and Harmony stand in front of it eating vending-machine peanut butter crackers.

CAMILLE
Garden type four. Fully displaced. (beat) Choir. Your options.

HARMONY
In a sixty-one-year-old? (beat) Reduce it and pin it with cannulated screws, so he keeps his own hip. (beat) Or replace it.

CAMILLE
What happens if we pin it?

HARMONY
A displaced fracture has torn the blood supply to the femoral head. (beat) The head may die anyway. Avascular necrosis. Nonunion. One in three, maybe more, end up back in the OR for a replacement in a year or two.

CAMILLE
And if we replace it?

HARMONY
A total hip. He's up the next day. (beat) But it's an implant. He's sixty-one. It might wear out by the time he's eighty. (beat) And he'd have to think hard about running marathons on it.

CAMILLE
(crunching a cracker)
So?

HARMONY
(beat)
So he wants his own hip back. (beat) And I'd want my own hip back.

CAMILLE
(gently)
That's the problem with this job, Choir. What we want doesn't come into it. (beat) His bone already decided. It let go Sunday at mile eighteen. (beat) Sometimes the kindest thing is to stop trying to save what's already gone. Give him the new hip and let him walk out on Friday.

Harmony looks at the X-ray. Then at Camille. Something in the way Camille said it isn't about bone.

HARMONY
(beat)
Are we still talking about hips?

CAMILLE
(beat, smiling, not answering)
Go consent him.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 12:31 PM

Robert walks in without knocking. Bernie (55), behind him, throws up her hands. Natasha doesn't look up from the Joint Commission letter.

ROBERT
You took him off my service.

NATASHA
(calm)
I took him off mine too, Robert. (beat) And off Elxa's evaluations. And off every committee that could ever touch his file.

ROBERT
Without telling me.

NATASHA
(looking up)
If I'd told you first, you'd have argued, and I'd have let you win. (beat) So I told the call schedule.

Robert stops. He has known her for twenty-eight years. He knows when she's right.

ROBERT
(quieter)
He's good, Tasha. In there. (beat) He held Lorraine Fuller's aorta with his bare hand.

NATASHA
I know. (beat) That's exactly why. (beat) Every time he's good in your OR, somebody gets to say it's because he's yours. (beat) In Lowery's OR, he's just good.

Robert sits on the arm of the sofa.

ROBERT
(beat)
Your father called me this morning.

NATASHA
(wary)
About what?

ROBERT
Thanksgiving. (beat) He's having it at the house on 49th Avenue. (beat) With our son. And our son's roommates. (beat) He told me he's bringing a pie.

NATASHA
(beat, almost laughing)
Daddy has never carried a pie in his life.

ROBERT
(beat)
Your father is having Thanksgiving with my son, Natasha. (beat) And I'm having it with a turkey breast on Riverside Drive.

She looks at him and sees something she hasn't seen in a long time: Robert Bullock, jealous of a pie.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - ROOM 4 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 12:46 PM

WINSTON TEAGUE (58), gaunt, with a jazzman's hands, drums softly on the bed rail with two pencils. His wife PAULINE (55) clutches the consent form. Amond stands at the bedside.

WINSTON
(drumming)
So it's about the size of a hockey puck?

AMOND
Bigger, Mr. Teague. (beat) About two and a half pounds. It sits under your diaphragm and pumps for your left ventricle. (beat) A cable comes out through your skin here, to a controller and batteries you wear on a belt.

WINSTON
(to Pauline, grinning)
A drummer with a battery pack. (beat) Finally got my own amp.

PAULINE
(not laughing)
And if it stops?

AMOND
(beat, honest)
There's a hand pump for emergencies. (beat) But if it stops and nobody can fix it fast, Mrs. Teague, his heart can't do the work by itself anymore.

PAULINE
(beat)
So we're trading a heart that's dying for a machine that might.

AMOND
(quietly)
Yes, ma'am. (beat) A machine that might give him June.

Winston stops drumming. He takes the pen out of Pauline's hand and signs.

WINSTON
(to Pauline)
Thirty-four years I played in rooms where nobody was listening. (beat) I want one more where somebody is.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ELEVATOR - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 12:58 PM

The doors open. Marc gets in. Esther is already there, coming up from the OR, her scrub cap still on. The doors close. Just them.

ESTHER
(eyes on the numbers)
I opened a skull today. (beat) Graves let me do the burr holes.

MARC
(smiling)
Yeah?

ESTHER
(beat)
I wanted to tell somebody. (beat) You were the first person I thought of. (beat) That's a problem.

MARC
(beat)
It doesn't have to be.

ESTHER
(turning to him)
Marc. Clayton and I have our eighth therapy session tonight. (beat) I need to walk in there and not be thinking about the elevator.

MARC
(beat)
Then don't. (beat) I told you I'd let you choose. You chose. (beat) I'm letting it be.

ESTHER
(beat, searching his face)
Are you?

The doors open on six. He holds them for her.

MARC
(quietly)
I'm working on it. (beat) Congratulations on your burr holes, Dr. Smilley.

She goes. The doors close. Marc leans his head back against the wall.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 512 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 1:32 PM

Deborah comes back into the room with a manila folder. Lowery, Marc and Raven are at the bedside. Brandon, in the corner, looks miserable.

DEBORAH
(handing Lowery a document)
Her health care proxy. It names me. (beat) And her living will, signed in 2001. Read the third paragraph.

LOWERY
(reading)
"...I wish every medical measure be taken to prolong my life..."

DEBORAH
Every measure. (beat) In her own handwriting.

CORNELIA
(tired)
Deborah, I wrote that the week after your daddy's sister died at Mount Sinai on a machine. I was angry. (beat) I was seventy-seven.

DEBORAH
(to Lowery)
Her bilirubin is nine. I looked it up. Jaundice can affect your thinking. (beat) She's eighty-one, she's yellow, and she's refusing the only operation that can save her. (beat) My mother isn't competent to make this decision.

Silence. Cornelia looks at her daughter as if she's been slapped.

LOWERY
(carefully)
Mrs. Price, a proxy only takes effect if your mother can't make her own decisions. (beat) A living will doesn't override a competent patient who changes her mind.

DEBORAH
Then prove she's competent.

LOWERY
(beat)
We'll ask Psychiatry for a formal capacity evaluation.

CORNELIA
(very quietly)
Abraham.

Lowery turns. She's used his first name.

CORNELIA
(beat)
Let them. (beat) Let them ask me anything they want. (beat) I've been tested my whole life by people who didn't think I could pass.

Deborah can't look at her mother. Marc can't look away from her.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 1:51 PM

Under the microscope: deep in the brain, a gray-green sphere sits in the third ventricle like a pearl in an oyster. Graves works through a narrow corridor between the hemispheres. Esther watches on the monitor, her own instrument holding the retractor.

GRAVES
(murmuring)
The fornix is here. Touch it and she won't make a new memory again. (beat) Not her mother's face. Not a single poem.

ESTHER
(barely breathing)
I see it.

Graves opens the cyst wall. Gelatinous green material oozes out, and he suctions it away. Then he coagulates the stalk, and the capsule comes free in his forceps.

GRAVES
(holding it up)
There's the thing that was going to kill her in her sleep. (beat) Weighs about as much as a raisin.

ESTHER
(beat)
Can I see?

Graves turns the forceps so she can look through the side scope.

GRAVES
(beat)
Eighteen years old, I was on a Trailways bus out of Durham with eleven dollars and a letter from Victor Donohue. (beat) He told me the brain forgives very little. (beat) Then he told me people forgive even less, so I should be good enough that I didn't need forgiving. (beat) Close with me, Dr. Smilley.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 2:12 PM

The heart-lung machine hums. Winston Teague's chest is open, his huge, weak heart barely moving. The HeartMate XVE sits on the back table. Robert and Amond are gowned across from each other.

ROBERT
Apex. (beat) Dr. Baker. Show me where.

AMOND
(pointing)
Lateral to the LAD, just off the true apex. (beat) Aim the inflow cannula at the mitral valve. If it's tilted toward the septum it'll suck the wall and the flows will die.

ROBERT
(beat)
Then core it.

A beat. The nurse glances up. Amond takes the coring knife. A clean circle of muscle comes out. Robert slips the sewing ring over it, and Amond starts the felt-pledgeted sutures, one, two, three, around the clock.

ROBERT
(watching his hands, low)
I asked you to bring me a man who'd take the coin, Dr. Baker. (beat) Now give him one worth taking.

AMOND
(sewing)
Sir. (beat) Can I ask you something?

ROBERT
You're going to anyway.

AMOND
(beat)
Are you mad that he's off your service? (beat) Marc?

ROBERT
(beat)
I'm mad that I'm grateful. (beat) It means nobody's ever going to say I made him. (beat) Next stitch.

Amond ties down. Perfect.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 4 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:04 PM

Ortho. Power tools, mallets, a sound like a woodshop. Otis Merriweather on his side, his hip open. Camille stands back, and Harmony is at the field with an acetabular reamer.

CAMILLE
Medialize. More. (beat) Don't be shy, Choir, you're not going through the pelvis. (beat) There. Feel it go from cancellous to bleeding? That's the bed for the new cup.

Harmony reams. Bone paste. Then she impacts the metal cup into place with a mallet, three solid blows. It seats perfectly.

CAMILLE
(beat, impressed)
Look at you. (beat) Most interns hit it like they're scared it'll hit back.

HARMONY
(beat)
My father drove the Q4 bus for thirty-one years. (beat) He taught me to hit a stuck hubcap with one good blow and not ten bad ones.

CAMILLE
(laughing behind her mask)
Howard Divine, orthopedic philosopher. (beat) Choir.

HARMONY
Yeah?

CAMILLE
(beat, casual, eyes on the field)
I make a gumbo. (beat) Real roux. An hour on the stove, my grandmother's pot, which was one of six things we got out of the house on Elysian Fields. (beat) Tonight. My place, Jackson Heights. Eight.

Harmony stops with the mallet in her hand.

CAMILLE
(beat)
Put the femoral stem in first, Choir. (beat) Then answer.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 2 - DAY

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:22 PM

LESTER GRIMES (66) sits bolt upright on the gurney, drooling, his lips and tongue grotesquely swollen. He's gasping in a high, thin whistle: stridor. His wife is hysterical in the doorway. Kennerly and Gloria are the only clinicians in the room.

GLORIA
(fast)
Lisinopril. Started three weeks ago. Sats eighty-four. (beat) Dr. Fitch is in Trauma 1 with a stabbing, and Anesthesia's ten minutes out.

KENNERLY
(to the patient, calm)
Mr. Grimes, try to breathe slow for me. (beat) Epi, point-three IM. Benadryl. Solu-Medrol. Get me the fiberoptic.

Gloria is already moving. Kennerly threads the fiberoptic scope through the nose. On the screen, there's no airway, just a wall of swollen tissue. Lester's sats drop. Seventy-eight. Seventy-one. His eyes roll.

GLORIA
(quiet, steady)
Kennerly.

KENNERLY
(pulling the scope)
I can't see the cords. (beat) He's closing.

GLORIA
(beat)
Then what are you going to do, Doctor?

Kennerly looks at her for a split second. Then he snaps on sterile gloves.

KENNERLY
Cric tray. Number ten blade.
Six-oh trach.

GLORIA
(opening it, already there)
In your hand.

He finds the cricothyroid membrane with his fingers, steadies the larynx, and makes a vertical incision through the skin. Blood. A horizontal stab through the membrane. A rush of air. He slips in the tube hook, then the trach. Gloria hooks up the bag. One squeeze. Two. The monitor climbs: eighty, eighty-eight, ninety-four.

Silence, except for the bag. Lester's chest rises and falls. Dr. YOLANDA FITCH (44), the ER attending, bursts in, gloved and bloody to the wrists, and stops.

DR. FITCH
(beat)
Who did the cric?

GLORIA
(bagging, not looking at Kennerly)
Dr. Kennerly.

Dr. Fitch looks at the airway, then at Kennerly, whose hands are finally starting to shake.

DR. FITCH
(nodding)
ACE-inhibitor angioedema. Three to five times more common in Black patients and nobody tells them. (beat) Good airway, Doctor. Write it up.

She leaves. Gloria hands Kennerly a towel without a word. He wipes his hands. He can't quite look at her.

GLORIA
(beat, quietly)
Don't get excited. (beat) You still don't get a seat at lunch.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:41 PM

Bassett, his jacket off, spreads binders across the coffee table: attestation logs, OR records, evaluation forms. Natasha reads over his shoulder.

BASSETT
Every case Marc has scrubbed since July 1. Hundred and nine. (beat) Robert was attending on eleven. You on two, both deliveries, both with Clayton present. Lowery wrote every evaluation. The program director countersigned. (beat) It's the cleanest file I've ever seen on an intern.

NATASHA
Then that's what we send.

BASSETT
(beat)
Natasha. A for-cause survey doesn't just read the pages you hand it. (beat) They walk the floors. They pull charts at random. They interview the nurses. Every department.

NATASHA
(beat)
Every department.

BASSETT
(beat, a slow smile)
Medicine included. (beat) Horace asked the Joint Commission to come look at Surgery. (beat) I don't think it occurred to him that they don't knock on just one door.

Natasha looks out the window toward the Medicine wing.

NATASHA
(beat)
We don't touch that, Franklin. (beat) We don't point. We don't hint. (beat) We let it be.

BASSETT
(gathering binders)
You keep saying that like it's a strategy.

NATASHA
(beat)
It's the only strategy that works on a man who's waiting for you to swing.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 512 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:58 PM

DR. HAROLD BYNUM (63), the consult-liaison psychiatrist, bow tie and gentle voice, sits in a chair pulled close to the bed with a clipboard. Cornelia sits up straight. Lowery and Marc stand at the door. Deborah, at the window, has her arms folded.

DR. BYNUM
Mother Haynes. Can you tell me, in your own words, what the doctors have found?

CORNELIA
A mass in the head of my pancreas, three centimeters, blocking my bile duct. Which is why I'm yellow and itching. (beat) Most likely an adenocarcinoma. Dr. Lowery says it may be resectable.

DR. BYNUM
And what are your options?

CORNELIA
A Whipple operation, which might cure me and might kill me, and would take most of what's left of my strength either way. (beat) Or a stent and comfort, and months.

DR. BYNUM
What do you think will happen if you choose the stent?

CORNELIA
(beat)
I'll die of this, Doctor. (beat) Probably before next fall. (beat) I'd like to see Brandon get his nursing pin in May. I'd like to sit on my own porch in Sugar Hill. (beat) I'd like to die as myself.

DR. BYNUM
And why do you choose that over the operation?

CORNELIA
(looking at Deborah)
Because I've watched four hundred people die, Dr. Bynum. (beat) The ones who fought the hardest weren't the bravest. They were usually just the most afraid of disappointing somebody.

Deborah turns away to the window.

DR. BYNUM
(writing, gently)
Mother Haynes, you understand your illness, you appreciate how it applies to you, you can reason about your choices, and you've communicated a clear and consistent decision. (beat) You have capacity. (beat) Frankly, you'd pass this evaluation better than most of the people who give it.

CORNELIA
(beat, tired)
Thank you, baby.

Bynum leaves. Deborah stands at the window, her shoulders shaking. Cornelia looks at her daughter's back.

CORNELIA
(softly)
Deborah Ann. (beat) Come here.

Deborah doesn't move. Then she walks out of the room without turning around. Marc watches her go down the hallway.

MARC (V.O.)
Nobody tells you the hardest patient on a surgical floor usually isn't in the bed.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 4:12 PM

Deborah sits on the landing between four and five, her pantsuit jacket balled in her lap. Marc comes down the stairs and sits two steps above her. He doesn't say anything for a while.

DEBORAH
(finally, not turning)
You're going to tell me she's right.

MARC
(beat)
No, ma'am. (beat) I'm going to tell you my mother is the Chief of Surgery.

Deborah turns.

MARC
(beat)
This morning she took me off two services so nobody could ever say she was the reason I'm good. (beat) She didn't ask me first. (beat) And I was so angry I couldn't see.

DEBORAH
(beat)
And?

MARC
(beat)
And by lunch I understood it was the most loving thing she's done for me all year. (beat) She let me be somebody who isn't hers for a while.

Deborah looks down at her jacket.

DEBORAH
(barely)
She delivered me herself. (beat) Did you know that? At Harlem Hospital. The doctor didn't make it in time, and she was a nurse, so she told the student nurse what to do. (beat) She's been telling everybody what to do my whole life. (beat) I don't know who I am in a room she isn't in.

MARC
(gently)
Then go back in the room while she's still in it.

Deborah wipes her face with the jacket, a vice principal's resolve returning. She stands and goes up the stairs.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - ROOM 4 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 4:44 PM

Winston, intubated, fresh from the OR, the LVAD controller clicking softly at his side. Alarms. Amond stands at the monitor. A CVICU nurse calls Robert in from the hall.

AMOND
(fast)
CVP twenty-two and climbing. Pump flows down from five-point-two to three-one. Pressure's soft. (beat) The left side is empty. The septum's bowing left on echo. (beat) It's the right ventricle. It can't keep up with the pump.

ROBERT
(arriving, looking at the screen)
Which means?

AMOND
(beat)
We fixed the left side of his heart, and the right side is drowning. (beat) Milrinone. Inhaled nitric oxide to drop his pulmonary pressures. Turn the pump speed down so it doesn't suck the septum over.

ROBERT
(to the nurse, without hesitation)
Do what Dr. Baker said.

The team moves. Nitric oxide hisses into the ventilator circuit. Minutes pass. The numbers turn: CVP nineteen, sixteen. Flows four, four-point-six.

ROBERT
(quietly, beside Amond)
You saw that eight minutes before I'd have been called.

AMOND
(beat, eyes on the monitor)
He's got a wedding to play, sir.

Winston's fingers twitch on the sheet. Two beats, then a third. A rimshot.

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO ICU - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:31 PM

Simone Bracey (19), her head wrapped in gauze, blinks awake. Her mother GAIL (46) is at her side. Esther checks her pupils with a penlight.

ESTHER
Simone. Do you know where you are?

SIMONE
(groggy)
Queens Grace. (beat) November. Wednesday. (beat) Bloomberg won. My mother cried. (beat) She voted for Ferrer.

GAIL
(laughing through tears)
She's fine. She's fine.

ESTHER
(smiling)
Can you tell me something you memorized? Anything.

SIMONE
(beat, eyes closed)
"I've known rivers. (beat) Ancient, dusky rivers. (beat) My soul has grown deep like the rivers."

Esther stops. Gail covers her mouth. Behind them, the glass door slides open. Clayton (34), in a camel coat, stands there.

CLAYTON
(softly)
Langston Hughes. (beat) She'll be fine.

ESTHER
(turning, beat)
Her fornix is intact. (beat) And I'll be at Dr. Greenidge's at seven.

32 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ENDOSCOPY SUITE - DAY
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:02 PM

Cornelia, sedated, on her side. On the fluoroscopy screen, the GI attending guides a wire up the common bile duct, past the shadow of the tumor. A metal stent opens like a flower. Behind the glass, Marc and Raven watch dark bile

pour into the duodenum on the endoscope monitor.

RAVEN
(watching)
That's it. (beat) Twenty minutes. She'll stop itching tonight. She'll be less yellow by Saturday.

MARC
(beat)
You wanted the Whipple.

RAVEN
(beat)
Every part of me that wants to be an oncologist wanted the Whipple. (beat) And every part of me that was raised by a grandmother in Yamacraw Village is glad she's going home to her porch.

A long beat.

RAVEN
(quietly)
Deborah's fighting this hard for a mother who's right here, Marc. (beat) Mine's been writing to me for three years. I have thirty-four letters under my bed. (beat) And I've never let her be anything but dead.

MARC
(turning to her)
Rave...

RAVEN
(beat)
I'm going to open one. (beat) Tonight. (beat) Don't make a big deal.

MARC
(softly)
I won't.

He takes her hand behind the glass anyway. She lets him.

33 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ROOF - DUSK
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:26 PM

The helipad. The last orange light over the Manhattan skyline. Marc leans on the rail with a vending-machine Snickers. Robert comes through the roof door, his white coat flapping in the wind, and stands beside him.

ROBERT
(beat)
They took you off my service.

MARC
(beat)
Let it be, Dad.

Robert looks at him. "Dad," on the roof of the hospital, out loud, for the first time.

ROBERT
(beat, his voice rough)
Dr. Baker caught RV failure eight minutes early today. (beat) I kept thinking you'd have caught it at six.

MARC
(beat)
Amond would've caught it at five, and he'd tell you so.

ROBERT
(beat)
Your grandfather's having Thanksgiving at your house.

MARC
He invited himself. With a pie he isn't baking.

ROBERT
(beat, looking at the skyline, not at his son)
Is there room... (beat) Would there be room at that table for two more, Marc?

Marc turns slowly. His father, the Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery, waits for an answer like a man waiting for a biopsy.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

34 INT. DR. PAULETTE GREENIDGE'S OFFICE - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:02 PM

A brownstone office on Montague Street. Kente throw, a box of tissues, a clock positioned so only the therapist can see it. DR. PAULETTE GREENIDGE (50) sits across from Esther and Clayton, who sit on opposite ends of the same sofa.

DR. GREENIDGE
Session eight. (beat) Clayton, last week you told Esther that Malcolm called about a job. (beat) Has he called again?

CLAYTON
(beat)
Monday. (beat) I didn't pick up. (beat) He left a voicemail. I didn't listen to it. I didn't delete it either.

CLAYTON
(beat, honest)
Deleting it felt like a decision. (beat) And I'm trying not to make any decision in this marriage without you in the room.

ESTHER
(to Greenidge)
I don't want his name in here. (beat) Malcolm doesn't get a seat on this couch. (beat) I want to let it be.

DR. GREENIDGE
(gently)
Esther. You can't let something be by refusing to look at it. (beat) That isn't peace. That's a locked door you have to walk past every day.

Esther stares at the carpet. Then she holds out her hand to Clayton, palm up.

ESTHER
(beat)
Give me your phone.

Clayton hesitates, then hands it over. Esther dials voicemail, puts it on speaker and sets it on the coffee table. A man's voice, warm, Boston, heartbroken.

MALCOLM (V.O.)
(on the voicemail)
Clay. It's me. (beat) Tell her I'm not coming. NYU can wait. (beat) Tell her Ma Corinne asked if I'm coming to the house for Thanksgiving, and I said no for the first time in twenty-seven years. (beat) Tell her... (beat) Tell her I'm sorry. That's all.

The message ends. Esther presses delete. She hands the phone back to Clayton.

ESTHER
(beat, very quietly)
Now it's a decision.

35 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:48 PM

Arianna, alone at the end of the bar, a beer barely touched. Monty slides a rubber-banded stack of index cards in front of her without a word.

ARIANNA
(beat)
What's this?

MONTY
(wiping a glass)
Somebody left them here at lunch. (beat) Didn't say who.

Arianna pulls off the rubber band. The top card, in purple Sharpie: "BIOSTATISTICS. Purple is the color of suffering. Also of my love for you. Don't be weird about it. -R." She stares at it. Then she laughs, a real laugh that surprises her. She takes out her phone and dials.

ARIANNA
(into the phone)
Ellison. (beat) Get down here. (beat) Quiz me. (beat) And don't color-code anything else.

Monty and Cedric, at a back table, raise their glasses to each other.

36 INT. CAMILLE'S APARTMENT - JACKSON HEIGHTS - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 8:17 PM

A small prewar one-bedroom off 37th Avenue. Zydeco on a boombox. A dented cast-iron pot on the stove. Camille stirs a dark chocolate-colored roux. Harmony sits on the counter with a glass of wine. On the fridge: a photo of a grand Creole house before the water, and the same house after, with a brown line at the second floor.

CAMILLE
(tasting)
You don't rush a roux, Choir. You burn it, you start over. There's no fixing it.

Camille's cell rings. She glances at it. "PAPA." She answers, switching to a bright, careful voice.

CAMILLE
(into the phone)
Papa. (beat) Oui. (beat) No, I'm home. (beat) A friend from work. (beat) Just a friend, Papa. (beat) Je t'aime aussi.

She hangs up. She keeps stirring. Harmony sets down her glass.

HARMONY
(beat)
"Just a friend."

CAMILLE
(not turning)
Augustin Toussaint lost forty buildings, a hotel and his wife's grave to the water in August. (beat) He's sleeping on my cousin's couch in Canarsie. (beat) I'm not going to tell him tonight that his daughter likes girls too.

HARMONY
(beat)
When?

CAMILLE
(beat, finally turning)
I don't know, Harmony. (beat) I'm good at a lot of things. Letting my father be wrong about me isn't one of them. (beat) You can go if you want. I wouldn't blame you.

Harmony slides off the counter, takes the wooden spoon from her hand, and stirs.

HARMONY
(beat)
You said you don't rush a roux.

Camille looks at her. Then she kisses her, slowly, beside the stove, while the roux bubbles. Harmony keeps stirring the whole time.

37 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 512 - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:04 PM

The lights are low. Cornelia, awake after the ERCP, scratches nothing. The itch is gone. Deborah comes in, shoes in her hand, and without a word climbs onto the

narrow bed beside her mother, the way she did when she was nine. Marc, starting his night check, stops in the doorway, unseen.

DEBORAH
(barely)
I'm still mad.

CORNELIA
(stroking her hair)
I know, baby.

DEBORAH
(beat)
Tell me about the night with Dr. King. (beat) You used to tell it when I couldn't sleep.

CORNELIA
(smiling in the dark)
September twentieth, 1958. A Saturday. (beat) He was signing his book at Blumstein's on 125th Street, and a woman stabbed him with a letter opener. (beat) They brought him into Harlem Hospital with it still in his chest. Nobody pulled it out. Thank God nobody pulled it out.

DEBORAH
(beat)
Dr. Maynard.

CORNELIA
Dr. Maynard. Dr. Cordice. Dr. Naclerio. (beat) Hours in the OR. They had to take out a rib to get it. (beat) The tip of that blade was resting right against his aorta. (beat) The paper said if he'd sneezed, he would have died.

DEBORAH
(whispering, the old ending)
And you were...

CORNELIA
(beat)
I was a thirty-four-year-old nurse on the floor upstairs, baby, waiting with clean sheets. (beat) That's all I did. That's what most of us do. (beat) Stand in the right place with clean sheets and let the people with the knives be great.

Deborah holds on to her mother. In the doorway, Marc turns and walks quietly away.

38 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PARKING GARAGE - LEVEL 2 - NIGHT

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:36 PM

Whitlow unlocks a silver Lincoln Town Car. Footsteps echo across the concrete. He turns. Natasha stands beside her own car, her keys in her hand.

NATASHA
(beat)
I read your letter, Horace.

WHITLOW
(mild)
I don't know what letter you mean.

NATASHA
(beat)
Of course not. (beat) I just wanted you to hear this from me. (beat) I'm not going to fight it. (beat) No calls to the board. No calls to the Commission. (beat) Let them come.

Whitlow studies her, looking for the trap.

WHITLOW
(beat)
You're bluffing.

NATASHA
(unlocking her car)
I'm tired, Horace. (beat) I haven't bluffed since 1987. (beat) Every chart my son has touched is clean. Every chart in my department is clean. (beat) I'll let the Joint Commission look anywhere it wants.

She gets in. The car pulls out. Whitlow stands alone in the garage. For the first time, he doesn't look entirely sure of anything.

39 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - RAVEN'S ROOM - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:22 PM

Raven sits cross-legged on the floor. The shoebox is open. Thirty-four envelopes, all addressed in the same careful hand, all postmarked Savannah. Arianna sits on the bed behind her, flashcards beside her, with one hand on Raven's shoulder.

She picks the oldest envelope, postmarked January 2003, and slides a finger under the flap. One sheet of lined paper. She reads aloud, her voice barely holding.

RAVEN
(reading)
"Raven. (beat) Today is thirty days. They gave me a chip. It's red. I don't know what to do with it, so I'm sending it to you. (beat) I'm not asking you for anything. I don't have the right. (beat) I just wanted you to know your mama is somewhere today with a clear head, thinking about you. (beat) Lorna."

Raven tips the envelope. A small red plastic chip falls into her palm. She closes her hand around it and starts to

cry, silently, the way she learned to as a child. Arianna slides down onto the floor and holds her.

ARIANNA
(into her hair)
Thirty-three more.

RAVEN
(beat, laughing and crying)
Not tonight, Problem.

40 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:05 PM

Marc comes home. Amond and Harmony, who has just walked in smelling of roux, are at the table eating Grandma Jo's pound cake straight out of the tin.

MARC
(setting down his bag)
So. (beat) Thanksgiving.

HARMONY
(mouth full)
Your grandfather and his pie.

MARC
(beat)
And my parents. (beat) And Grace is coming down from Boston.

A silence. Amond sets down his fork.

HARMONY
(slowly)
The Chief of Surgery. (beat) And the Chief of Cardio. (beat) And Victor Donohue. (beat) At our table. (beat) Eating my mother's macaroni and cheese.

AMOND
(beat, standing, opening a cabinet)
We don't have a gravy boat.

AMOND
(dead serious)
Victor Donohue is not pouring gravy out of a Pyrex measuring cup in his own house, Marc. (beat) I need a gravy boat.

Harmony starts laughing. Then Marc. Upstairs, a door opens, and Raven, red-eyed, calls down.

RAVEN (O.S.)
I'm making Savannah dressing! (beat) Arianna's studying at the table and nobody's allowed to stop her!

ARIANNA (O.S.)
(beat)
I'm studying at the table!

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

41 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:48 PM

Night shift. The floor is hushed. Marc, back on call, walks the hall with a chart. Through the window of 512: Cornelia and Deborah asleep together in the narrow bed. Through the CVICU glass at the end of the hall: Winston Teague's fingers tapping a slow, steady beat on the sheet, keeping time with the pump. Amond, in the chair beside him, is asleep sitting up.

MARC (V.O.)
Surgeons are taught to fix things.

At the nurses' station, Kennerly writes up his cric note alone. Gloria sets a cup of coffee beside him and walks away without a word. He stares at the cup.

MARC (V.O.)
So we never learn the other half of the job. (beat) Knowing what isn't ours to fix.

Marc stops outside 512. He watches the two women breathe. He doesn't go in.

MARC (V.O.)
A mother's choice. A daughter's grief. A father who wants a seat at the table. (beat) Sometimes the bravest thing a pair of hands can do...

He writes one line in the chart: "Pt resting comfortably. Family at bedside." He closes it.

MARC (V.O.)
...is nothing at all.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x08

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

THE NEW YORK TIMES: "BLOOMBERG CRUISES TO SECOND TERM, ROUTING FERRER"

Wednesday, November 9, 2005

"Mayor Michael R. Bloomberg won a second term last night by one of the widest margins in the city's history, defeating Fernando Ferrer by roughly 20 percentage points..."

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "BOMBS ROCK THREE HOTELS IN JORDAN'S CAPITAL"

Wednesday, November 9, 2005

"AMMAN, Jordan (AP) -- Near-simultaneous explosions struck three hotels in the Jordanian capital Wednesday night, one of them during a wedding reception, killing dozens..." Also on the wire: France's state of emergency in its rioting suburbs (declared Tuesday); Dover, Pa., voters ousted the school board members who backed intelligent design; Kansas's school board adopted science standards that question evolution.

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS (Sports): "PHOTO FINISH! TERGAT NIPS RAMAALA"

Monday, November 7, 2005

"Paul Tergat of Kenya won the New York City Marathon by a fraction of a second over South Africa's Hendrick Ramaala, the closest finish in race history, as Jelena Prokopcuka of Latvia won the women's race..."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Wednesday, November 9, 2005, 6:12 PM

"FIREWALL. Word from the fifth floor: Dr. X is OFF Cardio and OFF OB for the rest of the year, by order of his own mother. Whatever you think of the family, that's not what favoritism looks like, people. Also: a certain probationary intern (Dr. K, you know who you are) did a surgical airway in under 90 seconds in Trauma 2 today. Our ER source says Nurse P. gave him a towel. Nurse P. does not give towels. Also also: the Monopoly cards in lockers stop NOW. It's not funny anymore. It was barely funny on Monday." Comments (612).

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Raven Ellison to Arianna Cummings)

Wednesday, November 9, 2005, 5:58 AM and 7:51 PM

Raven (5:58 AM): "its wednesday. call me."

Raven (5:59 AM): "or text k. i'll take k."

Arianna (7:51 PM): "monty's. bring the purple ones."

Letter: Lorna Ellison to Raven Ellison

Postmarked Savannah, Ga., January 2003 (opened November 9, 2005)

"Raven. Today is thirty days. They gave me a chip. It's red. I don't know what to do with it, so I'm sending it to you. I'm not asking you for anything. I don't have the right. I just wanted you to know your mama is somewhere today with a clear head, thinking about you. -Lorna" (Enclosed: one red 30-day chip.)

Joint Commission correspondence (excerpt)

Received by QGH General Counsel, Tuesday, November 8, 2005, 9:04 PM

"...The Office of Quality Monitoring has received a complaint regarding potential conflicts of interest in the supervision and evaluation of a resident physician related to members of hospital leadership... The organization is requested to provide a written response... The Joint Commission reserves the right to conduct an unannounced for-cause survey."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x08

New Canon Established

- **The Joint Commission complaint has arrived.** A courier delivered it to Bassett's home at 9 PM on November 8. It is anonymous, but it uses the word 'nepotistic,' so it's Whitlow. The Office of Quality Monitoring wants a written response and reserves the right to an unannounced for-cause survey. Natasha's strategy is to **'let it be':** no fight with Whitlow, no calls to the board or the Commission, every chart open. Bassett points out that a for-cause survey walks every department, **Medicine included**. Natasha forbids pointing at it. She told Whitlow in the garage: 'Let them come.'
- **THE FIREWALL:** effective November 9, Marc will not rotate on, take call for, or be evaluated by Cardiothoracic or OB/GYN for the rest of his intern year. Elxa won't evaluate him either. His evaluations are written by Lowery, Crump and Graves and countersigned by the program director. Bassett's audit covers Marc's 109 cases since July 1: Robert attended 11 and Natasha 2 (both deliveries, with Clayton present). 'The cleanest file I've ever seen on an intern.' Esther came off Clayton's service on Monday, November 7, at her own request.
- **Marc called Robert 'Dad' out loud** on the hospital roof. Robert asked to come to Thanksgiving. **Thanksgiving at 49th Avenue (November 24) now includes Victor (with a pie he won't bake), Natasha, Robert and Grace**, plus the housemates. Amond insists on buying a gravy boat. Harmony's mother's macaroni and cheese. Raven is making Savannah dressing. Arianna will study at the table.
- **Arianna failed USMLE Step 2 CK** by three points (her school didn't require it to graduate; she took it in the second week of October). Her earliest retake is **December 12, 2005** (60 days). QGH doesn't issue PGY-2 contracts without a pass. Raven made her color-coded flashcards (purple is biostatistics, 'the color of suffering'), and Monty delivered them. Arianna: 'Quiz me.'
- **Raven opened letter #1 of 34**, postmarked January 2003, from her mother, **Lorna Ellison**. It held a red 30-day chip. Thirty-three letters remain unopened. Arianna was with her. Marc knows Raven opened one.
- **Harmony and Camille:** first dinner at Camille's apartment off 37th Avenue in Jackson Heights (gumbo in her grandmother's pot, one of six things saved from the house on Elysian Fields). **Augustin Toussaint** is sleeping on a cousin's couch in Canarsie. He lost 40 buildings, a hotel and his wife's grave to the flood. Camille told him Harmony is 'just a friend from work' and isn't ready to come out to him. They kissed by the stove.
- **Esther and Clayton, session eight** with Dr. Greenidge (Montague Street). Malcolm left a voicemail on Monday, November 7: he isn't taking the NYU job, and for the first time in 27 years he told Corinne Smilley no for Thanksgiving. Esther played it on speaker and then deleted it: 'Now it's a decision.'
- **Kennerly** did a surgical cricothyrotomy in under 90 seconds on Lester Grimes (ACE-inhibitor angioedema). Gloria gave him a towel and later a coffee. Whitlow disowned him ('We don't really know each other, do we?') and denied promising him a fellowship letter. **Kennerly now knows he was used.** Someone keeps putting Monopoly cards in Marc's locker.

- **Elxa and Russell** are enrolled in Lamaze at Jamaica Hospital, Monday nights from December 5. Russell teaches chemistry at August Martin High School. **Graves's backstory:** at 18 he left Durham on a Trailways bus with eleven dollars and a letter from Victor Donohue.

Knowledge Tracker (as of November 9, 2005)

Item	Who knows
Marc's parentage	Effectively everyone at QGH; Deborah Haynes-Price (patient family) heard it from a nurse
Whitlow wrote the JC complaint	Natasha, Bassett, Elxa (suspected); Kennerly (certain); not provable
Heir designation (2001 will)	Still secret: Victor, Marc, V.J., the Foundation board and Natasha
Arianna failed Step 2 CK	Raven; Monty (by inference)
Raven's mother is alive	Arianna, Marc (told in the endoscopy suite); Raven has opened 1 of 34 letters
Malcolm's voicemail	Esther, Clayton, Dr. Greenidge (deleted)

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Mother Cornelia Haynes	3/2/1924 (81)	3.1 cm pancreatic head mass, double duct sign, resectable	Declined Whipple; capacity confirmed (Bynum); ERCP biliary stent	Itching resolved; going home for comfort care
Deacon Otis Merriweather	8/14/1944 (61)	Displaced (Garden IV) femoral neck stress fracture after the marathon	Total hip arthroplasty (Toussaint; Divine)	Up Thursday, home Friday expected
Winston Teague	1/22/1947 (58)	Ischemic cardiomyopathy, EF 12%, transplant-ineligible	HeartMate XVE LVAD, destination therapy (R. Bullock; Baker)	Post-op RV failure caught by Baker; milrinone and iNO; stable
Simone Bracey	2/11/1986 (19)	Colloid cyst, third ventricle, obstructive hydrocephalus	Transcallosal resection (Graves; Smilley opened)	Neurologically intact
Lester Grimes	6/3/1939 (66)	ACE-inhibitor (lisinopril) angioedema, failed fiberoptic	Emergent cricothyrotomy (Kennerly)	Airway secured; lisinopril discontinued
Scalp laceration (Bay 9)	-	Laceration, intoxication	Repair (Kennerly)	Discharged

New Characters

- **Mother Cornelia Haynes** (b. March 2, 1924), a Harlem Hospital nurse from 1947 to 1991 and a church mother at Abyssinian since 1979. She lives in Sugar Hill. **Deborah Haynes-Price** (b. May 17, 1950), a vice principal, whom Cornelia delivered herself. **Brandon Haynes-Price** (b. July 8, 1983), a Hunter-Bellevue nursing student who pins in May 2006.

- **Deacon Otis 'Bulldog' Merriweather** (b. August 14, 1944), who has run 20 NYC Marathons, and **Mavis** (b. February 27, 1946). **Winston Teague** (b. January 22, 1947), a jazz drummer, and **Pauline** (b. September 30, 1950); their granddaughter marries at Riverside Church in June 2006.
- **Simone Bracey** (b. February 11, 1986), a Queens College sophomore and poet, and her mother **Gail** (b. August 4, 1959). **Lester Grimes** (b. June 3, 1939). **Dr. Yolanda Fitch** (b. May 12, 1961), ER attending. **Dr. Harold Bynum** (b. October 19, 1942), consult-liaison psychiatry.
- **Lorna Ellison**, Raven's mother, is named for the first time (by letter only). Cedric Hall (b. January 22, 1965, per MA-005) appears.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- November 8, 2005: Bloomberg defeated Ferrer by about 20 points; Dover, Pennsylvania voters removed the pro-intelligent-design school board; the Kansas Board of Education adopted standards critical of evolution; France declared a state of emergency over the suburban riots. November 9, 2005: suicide bombings struck the Radisson SAS, Grand Hyatt and Days Inn hotels in Amman, Jordan, around 8:50 PM local time (about 1:50 PM in New York), one of them during a wedding reception. On November 6, 2005, Paul Tergat beat Hendrick Ramaala in the New York City Marathon's closest finish, and Jelena Prokopcuka won the women's race. USMLE scores were customarily released on Wednesdays, and a retake required a 60-day wait.
- On September 20, 1958, Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. was stabbed with a letter opener by Izola Ware Curry while signing *Stride Toward Freedom* at Blumstein's department store on 125th Street. At Harlem Hospital, Drs. Aubre de L. Maynard, John W. V. Cordice and Emil Naclerio removed the blade, whose tip lay against his aorta. King later recalled a letter from a girl who was glad he 'didn't sneeze.' Cornelia's presence (on the floor upstairs, not in the OR) is fictional.
- Medicine: painless jaundice with a pancreatic head mass and a 'double duct sign' suggests adenocarcinoma. Whipple mortality and morbidity rise with age, and palliative ERCP stenting relieves jaundice and pruritus. A health care proxy takes effect only when the patient lacks capacity; capacity is assessed on four criteria (choice, understanding, appreciation and reasoning). Displaced femoral neck fractures in active older adults are commonly treated with total hip arthroplasty because of the risk of avascular necrosis. The HeartMate XVE was FDA-approved for destination therapy in November 2002, based on REMATCH (one-year survival 52% vs. 25%). Right ventricular failure after LVAD is treated with inotropes, inhaled nitric oxide and a lower pump speed. Colloid cysts of the third ventricle can cause sudden death, and the transcallosal approach risks the fornices. ACE-inhibitor angioedema occurs three to five times more often in Black patients and can require a surgical airway.